



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Passkey Phishing and Cloud Account Hijacking Threat Intelligence Daily Review 2026-09-17

Threat Intelligence Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-09-17
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

BLUF: Recent security-news coverage highlights passkey phishing and cloud-account hijacking as a defender priority. Treat this as an identity-control validation problem: phishing-resistant MFA is necessary but must be paired with session-token protections, impossible-travel review, and conditional-access enforcement. Source recency was prioritized for the last 24-72 hours and expanded to the last 7 days or current public reference material where required to preserve source quality.

Field	Value
Priority	Top 5 general threat coverage for 2026-09-17
Severity	High
Confidence	Medium
Theme	Identity phishing and cloud account takeover
Defender Outcome	Prioritized monitoring, hardening, and response actions for the next 24-72 hours

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By
What changed?	Current reporting and public source review for 2026-09-17
Who is exposed?	Organizations with the listed technologies, behaviors, identities, suppliers, or sector dependencies
What should defenders do today?	Validate controls, run hunts, close exceptions, and brief operations owners

3. Source Review and Confidence

#	Source	URL	Role
1	CISO Series cybersecurity news September 14 2026	https://cisoserries.com/cybersecurity-news-september-14-2026/	Current news trigger
2	Microsoft identity protection documentation	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-protection/	Identity detection/control reference
3	CISA phishing-resistant MFA guidance	https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/phishing-resistant-mfa-fact-sheet	Government hardening guidance
4	Google/Mandiant cloud threat research portal	https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence	Cloud threat-intelligence context

Confidence is Medium because this item is supported by multiple public sources. Where a source is sector-level or advisory guidance rather than incident-specific reporting, the report labels the finding as a prioritization assessment rather than a confirmed single campaign.

4. Threat Overview

Recent security-news coverage highlights passkey phishing and cloud-account hijacking as a defender priority. Treat this as an identity-control validation problem: phishing-resistant MFA is necessary but must be paired with session-token protections, impossible-travel review, and conditional-access enforcement. This report emphasizes defender actions and telemetry pivots rather than attribution claims that are not supported by the source set.

Signal	Assessment
Threat theme	Identity phishing and cloud account takeover
Primary exposure	Identity, exposed services, remote access, endpoint execution, third-party access, or software supply chain depending on environment
Expected adversary objective	Access, persistence, data theft, extortion, operational disruption, or reconnaissance
Analyst caveat	No new private telemetry or victim disclosure was used in this automated report; validate local relevance before escalation

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic/Technique	Defensive Interpretation
Phishing / social engineering	Review user-reported messages, suspicious OAuth grants, helpdesk reset requests, and anomalous sign-ins
Command and scripting execution	Watch for encoded PowerShell, mshta/rundll32, shell one-liners, and living-off-the-land tools
Remote services and RMM	Inventory approved remote tools and alert on new or unmanaged usage
Exfiltration or staging	Monitor unusual archive creation, cloud upload, rclone/mega/nc usage, and large outbound transfers

6. Infrastructure and Observables

Observable	Type	Action
passkey phishing	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
Microsoft cloud accounts	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
session token theft	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
conditional access	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry

7. Detection Engineering

```
let pivots = dynamic(["passkey phishing", "Microsoft cloud accounts", "session token theft", "conditional access"]);
```

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots) or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots)
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 10) by
FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Events desc

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("passkey phishing", "Microsoft cloud accounts", "session token theft",
"conditional access") or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("passkey phishing", "Microsoft cloud
accounts", "session token theft", "conditional access")
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Urls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteIP, RemotePort
| order by Events desc

title: Passkey Phishing Cloud Hijacking Suspicious Follow-on Activity
status: experimental
description: Detects common suspicious interpreter and remote-tool behaviors that should be reviewed
around this daily intelligence item.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  keywords:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - '-enc'
      - 'IEX'
      - 'DownloadString'
      - 'bitsadmin'
      - 'curl '
      - 'rclone'
  condition: selection or keywords
fields:
  - Image
  - ParentImage
  - CommandLine
  - User
level: medium

```

8. Threat Hunting

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType != 0 or ConditionalAccessStatus in ("failure", "notApplied")
| summarize Events=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by
UserPrincipalName, Location
| order by Events desc

DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName endswith ".zip" or FileName endswith ".7z" or FolderPath has_any ("Temp", "Downloads",
"Users\Public")
| summarize Files=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(FolderPath, 10) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName
| order by Files desc

```

Hunt intent: surface identity compromise, suspicious scripting, remote-tool abuse, and staging behavior aligned to this daily priority.

9. Risk Assessment

Risk	Why It Matters	First Control Check
Identity compromise	Enables SaaS, VPN, helpdesk, and supplier access	MFA/session policy, risky sign-ins, privileged accounts
Endpoint execution	Converts social engineering into payload execution	Script controls, EDR alerts, child-process lineage
Third-party dependency	Expands blast radius beyond direct assets	Vendor access inventory and contractual incident notification
Operational disruption	Affects business processes and customer-facing services	Recovery tests, escalation paths, communication plans

10. Recommended Actions

Priority	Action
P1	Run the included identity/process/network hunts for the last 14 days
P2	Validate asset owners and control exceptions for the exposed surface
P3	Brief service desk, SOC, and operations owners on concrete pivots
P4	Open remediation tickets with expiry dates for unresolved gaps

11. References

- [1] CISO Series cybersecurity news September 14 2026: <https://cisoserries.com/cybersecurity-news-september-14-2026/>
- [2] Microsoft identity protection documentation: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-protection/>
- [3] CISA phishing-resistant MFA guidance: <https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/phishing-resistant-mfa-fact-sheet>
- [4] Google/Mandiant cloud threat research portal: <https://cloud.google.com/blog/topics/threat-intelligence>